

IN TEST

15
PROCESSORS

AMD Athlon XP 1600+



AMD Athlon XP 1500+



AMD Athlon XP 1800+



AMD Duron 900 MHz



AMD Athlon 1.13 GHz



Intel Celeron 1.2 GHz



Intel Celeron 800 MHz

How fast is fast? Very slow, if you take the pace at which processors break speed barriers. We give you three simple facts here: speed, power and price. It's time to overclock!

The last time you ever tried working in Photoshop on a 233 MHz processor? You probably had to go watch a movie at a theatre near you while your machine was busy saving the file. Running more than one application on a 233 MHz processor was almost unthinkable.

Today, when your computer runs many applications simultaneously, you need some serious power. In answer to this increasing demand for speed and power, how do we push the performance barriers?

By changing the processor.

But this is just the beginning. The performance of a CPU is related to the way your PC is configured. Yes, you will get a performance jump when you upgrade or buy a newer, faster processor, but to achieve maximum utilisation, you have to tweak it to perfection. To complicate matters further, there is a wide array of processor interfaces, RAM standards, formats, chipsets and platforms to choose from. PCs have moved from one standard to the other so rapidly that today we have a jamboree of processors with no common *de facto* standard or platform—in some cases,

Process